



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "against compatibilist free will" in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee.
2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee, then her act of poisoning the coffee is free.
3. Isabel's act of poisoning the coffee is free.
(1,2)
4. Isabel had no choice about the chip being inserted into her brain.
5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain necessitates that she will poison the coffee.

- C. An act can be free even if it is necessitated by facts about which the agent has no choice.
(3,4,5)

THE FRANKFURT ARGUMENT

In the present case, one might say that Isabel's free actions included
“deciding on her own to poison the coffee.” **That** action was not
necessitated by the chip; so saying that it is free is no counterexample to
Necessitation/No Choice.

But if that action is free, that might explain how (1) can be true despite
(2) being false.



1. Isabel is responsible for providing the coffee.

5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain

4. Isabel had no chance about the chip being

(1, 2)

coftee, then her act of poisoning the coffee is

inserted into her brain.

3. Isabel's act of imprisoning the confessor is free.

2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the

Can't act can be free even if it is not at all

neccessitates that she will provide.

(3, 4, 5)





by facts about which the agent has no choice.



Necessitation/~~No~~ Choice.

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But if that action is free, that might explain how (1) can be true despite

(2) being false.



2. None has any choice about DIDS ATJR.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws



1. No one has any choice about events which

of interest.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

happened in the distant past.

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

then DECISION. (4,5)

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)



varlatatie + the last of the

future is not just what the state of the

about whether @.

then DECISION happens. (3)

and none has any choice about whether,

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

3. If determined, the only one

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

theorie about the fact that if DNR

combination of four - that No



rules out free will.

choice about the laws of nature, then no

This argument seems to show that the

choice principle, and determinism

one has any choice about the past, no

seem quite plausible, the argument

true, there are no free actions — and

seems to show that if determinism is

hence that free will is incompatible with

Since the first three of these theses

dearminism.





2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

Wili.



0: There is no fire in.



Real/|the master argument:

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

against
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**against
incompatibilist
free will**

reality of free will.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the



Wili.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.



0. There is no fire in.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

for (2), and one for (3).

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one